RDG-P6 · PRÁCTICA 03

Gapped text

Hoja 03 · Ensayo argumentativo · dificultad 3 de 4

7 huecos (37–43) · 8 párrafos (A–H), uno sobrante · 2 puntos por hueco · tiempo orientativo: 18 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

You are going to read an extract from an essay about finding one's way. Seven paragraphs have been removed from the extract. Choose from the paragraphs **A–H** the one which fits each gap (37–43). There is one extra paragraph which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

The uses of getting lost

Satellite navigation has all but abolished one of life's minor ordeals. It may have taken something else with it.

It has become remarkably difficult to get lost. A phone in the pocket knows where we are to within a few metres, and a calm voice tells us when to turn, how far we still have to go and when we are likely to arrive. I would not want to give any of this up. Yet I notice that I can now spend a week in a city I have never visited and come home with almost no idea of how its streets fit together.

37 _____

What it left behind may even be visible. In 2000 a team at University College London scanned the brains of London taxi drivers, who must memorise some twenty-five thousand streets to earn their licence, and found that the rear of the hippocampus, a region closely involved in spatial memory, was larger than in other people, and larger still the longer they had been driving. A later study, which followed trainees through their years of preparation, found the same region growing in those who qualified.

38 _____

Enthusiasts for the technology are unmoved by such findings, and their argument deserves a fair hearing. Navigation, they say, is a skill like any other, and a skill that machines perform better than we do is one we can afford to lose. Few people can still do long division on paper, and nobody thinks the worse of them for it. Why should finding the way to the station be any different?

39 _____

I had this brought home to me in Naples last spring. I spent four days there with my phone in my hand, arriving punctually everywhere I meant to go, and I remember almost nothing of the city in between: a sequence of left turns, a blue dot advancing along a grey line. On the last afternoon the battery died, and I spent two hours finding my way back to the hotel. Those two hours are the only part of the visit I can still walk through in my mind.

40 _____

The real choice, then, is not between the phone and the paper map, but between two ways of using the phone. One treats it as a driver, issuing instructions that we follow without thinking, and it is unquestionably the quicker of the two. The other treats it as a map: something to consult before setting out, and again when we go astray, but which leaves the actual finding of the way to us.

41 _____

It will be objected that this is a counsel for people with time on their hands. Commuters, delivery drivers and parents on the school run cannot afford to wander, and nobody is suggesting that they should. But most of us also move through places with no deadline at all: on holiday, at weekends, on the way back from somewhere we had no need to hurry to. It is there that the phone could stay in the pocket.

42 _____

A loss of that kind would be difficult to measure and easy to dismiss. It would show itself not in examination results but in something vaguer: a reluctance to set off without instructions, an unease in any place where the signal fails, a sense of the world as a series of destinations with nothing much in between. It would also perpetuate itself, since a skill that nobody misses is a skill that nobody thinks to teach.

43 _____

Being lost on purpose is not, of course, quite the same as being lost. The phone is still there, and with it the certainty of rescue. But the streets do not know that, and nor, after the first few turnings, does the part of the mind that has to make sense of them. Sooner or later a place begins to assemble itself in the head, and that is something no blue dot can do for us.

A The effect seems to work in the other direction too. When researchers in Montreal tested how well people could find their way without help, those who relied most on satellite navigation did worst, and when some of them were tested again three years later, the heaviest users had declined the most. The study was small, and its findings will need confirming, but the pattern is hard to ignore.

B The case is stronger still for children. A generation that has never had to find its own way to school or to a friend's house may reach adulthood without ever building the kind of mental map that its grandparents took for granted. It may not even know that anything is missing.

C None of this is a reason to throw the phone into the sea. Satellite navigation has made strange cities far less daunting, and for the elderly, the anxious and those with no sense of direction at all, it has opened up places they would once have avoided altogether. To dismiss gains of that kind as trivial would be a form of snobbery.

D Seen in this light, the enthusiasts have a point. Navigation is a skill whose time has passed, and there is no more reason to mourn it than to mourn the ability to shoe a horse or read the sky for rain. The sensible course is to accept the loss with good grace and to spend the time saved on something more rewarding.

E It was not always so. Finding one's way in an unfamiliar place used to mean building a map of it in one's head: noticing that the cathedral lay downhill from the station, that the river was somewhere to the left, that the market could be reached by two routes. The process was slow and often humiliating. It was also a form of learning, and it left something behind.

F It need not come to that, and the remedy is hardly demanding. It is to get lost now and then on purpose: to put the phone away in a town we do not know, pick a direction and see where it leads. At worst, we arrive somewhere late.

G Because the comparison misunderstands what finding the way is for. A calculator returns the answer we would have reached ourselves, only faster; nothing is lost on the way, because the way has no value of its own. A route is different. The streets we pass through are not an obstacle between us and our destination. For a visitor, they are very often the point.

H The second is slower, and it will sometimes lead us wrong. That is no small part of its value. The errors it permits, the wrong turning taken and then corrected, are what fix a place in the memory; a route we have never been allowed to get wrong is a route we have never really learned.

Hoja de respuestas

Marca una sola letra por hueco; cada letra se usa una vez como máximo. Al corregir, 2 puntos por acierto; los errores no restan. Anota también el tiempo empleado: el objetivo en el examen son unos 18 minutos.

Nº	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	Puntos
37	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
38	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
39	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
40	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
41	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
42	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
43	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	/ 2
							Total		**/ 14**

Párrafo sobrante: _____ (no puntúa; sirve para comprobar). Tiempo empleado: _____ minutos.

SOLUCIONES

2 puntos por acierto. Cada solución explica qué une el párrafo con lo de antes (←) y con lo de después (→), con citas de los dos lados; cuando hay un párrafo tentador, por qué falla; y, al final, por qué el sobrante no entra en ningún hueco. Los números de sección remiten a RDG-P6_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	Empieza	Teoría
37	**E**	It was not always so.	§4.1 · §4.2
38	**A**	The effect seems to work in the…	§4.1 · §4.4
39	**G**	Because the comparison misunderstands what finding the…	§3.2 · §4.1
40	**C**	None of this is a reason to…	§3.2 · §4.3
41	**H**	The second is slower, and it will…	§4.1 · §3.2
42	**B**	The case is stronger still for children.	§4.1 · §4.4
43	**F**	It need not come to that, and…	§4.1 · §4.2
—	**D**	Seen in this light, the enthusiasts have… *(sobrante)*	§5.1 · §4.5

Explicación por hueco

37 · E · *It was not always so.*

← Con lo anterior. El primer párrafo describe la situación actual: el autor vuelve de un viaje with almost no idea of how its streets fit together. E la contrapone al pasado con una frase breve y sin conector: It was not always so (§4.1, contraste implícito).

→ Con lo siguiente. E termina con una idea que deja algo pendiente: it left something behind. El párrafo siguiente la retoma casi palabra por palabra para desarrollarla: What it left behind may even be visible (§4.2).

Tentador: C. None of this is a reason to throw the phone into the sea encaja por detrás, porque el primer párrafo ya dice I would not want to give any of this up. Pero C no contiene nada a lo que pueda referirse What it left behind, y una concesión tan temprana no tiene todavía ningún argumento que matizar.

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §4.2 Pistas hacia delante

38 · A · *The effect seems to work in the other direction…*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior muestra que aprender rutas agranda una zona del cerebro (found the same region growing in those who qualified). A retoma ese hallazgo con un sustantivo resumen y anuncia el caso contrario: The effect seems to work in the other direction too.

→ Con lo siguiente. A termina valorando su estudio (the pattern is hard to ignore). El párrafo siguiente agrupa los dos estudios con otro sustantivo resumen: Enthusiasts for the technology are unmoved by such findings. Sin A, la expresión such findings no incluiría ningún dato sobre la navegación por satélite, que es lo único que podría inquietar a sus defensores.

Tentador: B. The case is stronger still for children supone un argumento ya planteado para los adultos, y en este punto el autor solo está reuniendo pruebas. Además, B no contiene ningún hallazgo al que pueda referirse such findings.

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §4.4 Cadenas léxicas

39 · G · *Because the comparison misunderstands what finding the way is…*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior expone la postura de los entusiastas y termina con una pregunta: Why should finding the way to the station be any different? G responde directamente con Because, y the comparison recoge la analogía de las divisiones (Few people can still do long division on paper). Es el patrón pregunta–respuesta y, a la vez, la réplica del autor (§3.2).

→ Con lo siguiente. G termina con la tesis del autor: las calles are very often the point. El párrafo siguiente la ilustra con una anécdota personal: I had this brought home to me in Naples. El demostrativo this recoge la idea de que el camino importa por sí mismo.

Tentador: D. Seen in this light, the enthusiasts have a point parece continuar la exposición de los entusiastas, pero convierte su postura en la del autor, deja sin respuesta la pregunta y la anécdota siguiente (I had this brought home to me) demuestra justo lo contrario (§4.5).

Teoría: §3.2 Hilo argumentativo · §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás

40 · C · *None of this is a reason to throw the…*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior cierra la anécdota a favor de perderse (the only part of the visit I can still walk through in my mind). C concede lo que el argumento podría parecer negar: None of this is a reason to throw the phone into the sea. Es una concesión del autor (§3.2), y None of this recoge todo lo dicho hasta ahí.

→ Con lo siguiente. C reconoce las ventajas del navegador y descarta la postura contraria como a form of snobbery. El párrafo siguiente saca la conclusión de esa concesión: The real choice, then, is not between the phone and the paper map. El adverbio then solo tiene sentido si antes se ha descartado prescindir del móvil.

Tentador: B. The case is stronger still for children podría ampliar la anécdota de Nápoles, pero falla por delante: The real choice, then se deduce de que no se puede renunciar al móvil, y B no concede nada parecido, sino que insiste en los riesgos. Además, B es el único párrafo que da antecedente a A loss of that kind.

Teoría: §3.2 Hilo argumentativo · §4.3 Conectores y adverbios de frase

41 · H · *The second is slower, and it will sometimes lead…*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior distingue dos maneras de usar el móvil, como conductor y como mapa (The other treats it as a map). H continúa con un ordinal: The second is slower.

→ Con lo siguiente. H defiende el valor de equivocarse (a route we have never been allowed to get wrong is a route we have never really learned). El párrafo siguiente anticipa una objeción a ese consejo: It will be objected that this is a counsel for people with time on their hands. Aceptar un camino más lento, que es lo que propone H, es justo lo que no puede permitirse quien tiene prisa.

Tentador: F. Encaja por delante, porque perderse a propósito también es a counsel for people with time on their hands. Pero falla por detrás: It need not come to that exige un peligro que lo anterior no plantea, y nada en F recoge las dos maneras de usar el móvil.

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §3.2 Hilo argumentativo

42 · B · *The case is stronger still for children.*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior responde a la objeción y concluye dónde dejar el móvil: It is there that the phone could stay in the pocket. B extiende el mismo argumento a otro grupo y lo refuerza: The case is stronger still for children. La palabra still indica que el argumento ya se ha defendido para los adultos.

→ Con lo siguiente. B termina con una pérdida que nadie notaría: It may not even know that anything is missing. El párrafo siguiente la retoma con un sustantivo resumen y la valora: A loss of that kind would be difficult to measure and easy to dismiss. La expresión easy to dismiss recoge que nadie la notaría.

Tentador: D. La pérdida que menciona D (to accept the loss with good grace) parece preparar A loss of that kind, pero D contradice lo que el autor acaba de defender (the phone could stay in the pocket), y el párrafo siguiente trata esa pérdida como algo serio.

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §4.4 Cadenas léxicas

43 · F · *It need not come to that, and the remedy…*

← Con lo anterior. El párrafo anterior describe en qué consistiría esa pérdida: a sense of the world as a series of destinations with nothing much in between. F responde a todo ese panorama con un pronombre: It need not come to that. El demostrativo that es el futuro que acaba de describirse.

→ Con lo siguiente. F propone perderse a propósito (to get lost now and then on purpose), y el último párrafo matiza esa propuesta empezando por ella: Being lost on purpose is not, of course, quite the same as being lost.

Teoría: §4.1 Pistas hacia atrás · §4.2 Pistas hacia delante

El párrafo sobrante

D · *Seen in this light, the enthusiasts have a point.*

- **Huecos 37 y 38.** the enthusiasts presupone que ya se ha presentado a los entusiastas, y eso no ocurre hasta el párrafo que empieza Enthusiasts for the technology, detrás del hueco 38 (§3.4).
- **Hueco 39.** Parece una concesión tras la postura de los entusiastas, pero deja sin respuesta la pregunta Why should finding the way to the station be any different?, y la anécdota siguiente (I had this brought home to me in Naples) ilustra justo lo contrario de lo que D afirma.
- **Huecos 40 y 41.** En estos puntos el autor ya ha defendido el valor de orientarse por uno mismo, y D lo contradice. Además, lo que sigue a cada hueco no encaja: The real choice, then no se deduce de aceptar la pérdida, y a counsel for people with time on their hands no puede referirse a un consejo que promete ahorrar tiempo.
- **Huecos 42 y 43.** En el 42 encaja por delante gracias al léxico (to accept the loss parece preparar A loss of that kind), pero contradice lo que el autor acaba de concluir (the phone could stay in the pocket), y el párrafo siguiente trata esa pérdida como algo grave, no como algo que se acepta con elegancia. En el 43 también contradice al autor, que acaba de presentar esa pérdida como un daño que se perpetúa (a skill that nobody misses is a skill that nobody thinks to teach), y no prepara Being lost on purpose.

Teoría: §5.1 Cómo se fabrica el sobrante · §4.5 Tiempo verbal y voz